MODULE 7

Tricksters and Tall Tales

"There is magic to storytelling."

— LYNN COLLINS

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What lessons can you learn from characters in traditional tales?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Thunder Rose**	· Jerdine Nolen (illus. Kadir Nelson)	TALL TALE
2	**In the Days of King Adobe**	· as told by Joe Hayes (illus. Ute Simon)	FOLKTALE
3	**A Pair of Tricksters**	· Aesop and John & Caitlin Matthews	FABLE / TRICKSTER TALE
4	**Ten Suns / The Ten Suns**	· retold by Eric A. Kimmel (illus. Yongsheng Xuan)	LEGEND & VIDEO

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B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 5

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 11

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 14

NAME _____ DATE _____

Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 7 · Tricksters and Tall Tales · Grade 4 · 25 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

legendary

If something is **legendary**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** brand new and never talked about.
- ◯ **B.** small and easy to forget.
- ◯ **C.** very famous and has had many stories told about it.
- ◯ **D.** made up and completely false.

Q2 L.4.6

exaggeration

An **exaggeration** is —

- ◯ **A.** a true list of facts.
- ◯ **B.** an exact, careful measurement.
- ◯ **C.** a description that makes something seem larger, better, or worse than it really is.
- ◯ **D.** a complete lie with no truth in it at all.

Q3 L.4.6

trickster

A **trickster** is —

- ◯ **A.** a person who always tells the truth.
- ◯ **B.** a king who rules a country.
- ◯ **C.** a character who is easily fooled or tricked by others.
- ◯ **D.** a character who deceives or tricks others, usually to get something from them.

Q4 L.4.6

shrewd

Someone who is **shrewd** is —

- ◯ **A.** able to quickly understand a situation to their advantage.
- ◯ **B.** slow to understand what is happening.
- ◯ **C.** foolish and easily tricked by others.
- ◯ **D.** always kind and gentle.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THUNDER ROSE

Q5 L.4.4

recall

The storyteller says she can **recall** the night Rose was born. When you **recall** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** forget it completely.
- ◯ **B.** shout it out loud.
- ◯ **C.** remember it.
- ◯ **D.** make it up for the very first time.

Q6 L.4.5 TRAP

vividly

She remembers the night **vividly**. If you remember something **vividly**, you remember it —

- ◯ **A.** in a blurry, fuzzy way.
- ◯ **B.** in a clear and detailed way.
- ◯ **C.** only in your dreams.
- ◯ **D.** not at all.

Q7 L.4.4

accentuated

If something is **accentuated**, it —

- ◯ **A.** is hidden out of sight.
- ◯ **B.** is kept exactly the same as before.
- ◯ **C.** has attention drawn to it.
- ◯ **D.** is made smaller and quieter.

Q8 L.4.5 TRAP

partial

Rose says she is **partial** to the name Rose. If you are **partial** to something, you —

- ◯ **A.** prefer it more than other things.
- ◯ **B.** only have a small part of it.
- ◯ **C.** are afraid of it.
- ◯ **D.** never want it at all.

Q9 L.4.5 TRAP

splendor

Rose's parents watch over her in **splendor**. The **splendor** of something is its —

- ◯ **A.** dull, plain look.
- ◯ **B.** heavy weight.
- ◯ **C.** loud sound.
- ◯ **D.** great beauty or magnificent appearance.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THUNDER ROSE (CONTINUED)

Q10 L.4.4

resourceful

Rose's ma is glad to have such a **resourceful** child. If you are **resourceful**, you are —

- ◯ **A.** afraid to try anything new.
- ◯ **B.** good at solving problems quickly.
- ◯ **C.** unable to do things on your own.
- ◯ **D.** rich and the owner of many things.

Q11 L.4.4

disposition

Rose has the sweetest **disposition**. Your **disposition** is —

- ◯ **A.** the job or position someone is given.
- ◯ **B.** the way a person looks on the outside.
- ◯ **C.** a sudden change in your mood for one moment.
- ◯ **D.** the way you tend to act or feel.

Q12 L.4.4

commendable

Rose did a **commendable** job of staking the fence. If you do something **commendable**, you —

- ◯ **A.** do it well and earn praise.
- ◯ **B.** do it carelessly and badly.
- ◯ **C.** refuse to do it at all.
- ◯ **D.** do it in a way that gets you into trouble.

Q13 L.4.5 TRAP

devastation

Rose faces the **devastation** of the windstorm. **Devastation** is —

- ◯ **A.** a gentle, peaceful rain.
- ◯ **B.** terrible damage or complete destruction.
- ◯ **C.** a happy celebration.
- ◯ **D.** a small repair to a fence.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · IN THE DAYS OF KING ADOBE

Q14 L.4.4

thrifty

The old woman is very **thrifty**. If you are **thrifty**, you —

- ◯ **A.** waste your money on everything.
- ◯ **B.** give all your money away at once.
- ◯ **C.** never have any money at all.
- ◯ **D.** save your money and buy only what you need.

Q15 L.4.5 TRAP

generous

The old woman cuts **generous** slices of ham for the travelers. If someone is **generous**, they —

- ◯ **A.** give or share more than is necessary.
- ◯ **B.** keep everything for themselves.
- ◯ **C.** give as little as possible.
- ◯ **D.** take food from other people.

Q16 L.4.4

character

Over the years the old woman became a good judge of **character**. A person's **character** is —

- ◯ **A.** the way a person looks on the outside.
- ◯ **B.** the town where they were born.
- ◯ **C.** the kind of person he or she is.
- ◯ **D.** the money they have saved.

Q17 L.4.4

fascinated

The old woman says she is **fascinated** by dreams. If you are **fascinated** by something, you are —

- ◯ **A.** bored by it.
- ◯ **B.** frightened of it.
- ◯ **C.** angry about it.
- ◯ **D.** very interested in it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · A PAIR OF TRICKSTERS

Q18 L.4.4

succulent

Raven spies a **succulent** crayfish in the lake. If food is **succulent**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** dry and tasteless.
- ◯ **B.** juicy and tasty.
- ◯ **C.** burnt and hard.
- ◯ **D.** cold and frozen.

Q19 L.4.5 TRAP

clamped

Raven keeps his beak **clamped** shut so he won't drop his dinner. If something is **clamped** shut, it is —

- ◯ **A.** held tightly shut.
- ◯ **B.** opened up wide.
- ◯ **C.** waved in the air.
- ◯ **D.** left loose and open.

Q20 L.4.4

gratitude

The people offer thanks as a sign of **gratitude**. When you show **gratitude**, you show that you are —

- ◯ **A.** thankful.
- ◯ **B.** angry.
- ◯ **C.** bored.
- ◯ **D.** afraid.

Q21 L.4.4

withered

In the heat of ten suns, the crops **withered** in the fields. If a plant has **withered**, it has —

- ◯ **A.** grown tall and green.
- ◯ **B.** dried up and possibly died.
- ◯ **C.** grown thick and full of fruit.
- ◯ **D.** burst into flower.

Q22 L.4.5 TRAP

scorching

People lay on the **scorching** ground. Something that is **scorching** is —

- ◯ **A.** cool and shady.
- ◯ **B.** very, very hot.
- ◯ **C.** wet and muddy.
- ◯ **D.** soft and grassy.

Q23 L.4.4

reckless

Di Jun must stop his sons' **reckless** walk across the sky. Someone who is **reckless** —

- ◯ **A.** always asks for permission first.
- ◯ **B.** is careful about every step.
- ◯ **C.** does not care how his or her actions affect others.
- ◯ **D.** moves very slowly and quietly.

Q24 L.4.5 TRAP

assumed

Finding no more arrows, Hu Yi **assumed** his work was done. If you **assumed** something, you —

- **A.** believed it without proof.
- **B.** proved it with careful tests.
- **C.** were told it by a messenger.
- **D.** wrote it down to remember it.

Q25 L.4.4

prosper

In the video *The Ten Suns*, listen for the word **prosper**. If you **prosper**, you —

- **A.** stay poor no matter how hard you try.
- **B.** fail and lose everything.
- **C.** stay exactly the same.
- **D.** succeed and do well.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 7 · Tricksters and Tall Tales · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3 · RL.4.5 · RL.4.6 · RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Thunder Rose

TALL TALE · JERDINE NOLEN (ILLUS. KADIR NELSON) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.4.2

What is "Thunder Rose" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How a real rancher fences in his cattle.
- ◯ **B.** The history of barbed wire factories.
- ◯ **C.** A larger-than-life girl with amazing powers who learns to trust the song in her own heart.
- ◯ **D.** A storm that destroys a quiet town.

Q2 RL.4.3

What does baby Rose do right after she is born that shows she is extraordinary?

- ◯ **A.** She grabs a bolt of lightning, rolls it into a ball, and talks to the doctor.
- ◯ **B.** She falls fast asleep.
- ◯ **C.** She cries quietly for her mother.
- ◯ **D.** She hides under a blanket.

Q3 RL.4.3

How does Rose change Tater, the cantankerous steer?

- ◯ **A.** She chases him out of the herd.
- ◯ **B.** She builds a fence to keep him out.
- ◯ **C.** She gives him to the outlaws.
- ◯ **D.** She hums her tune until he calms down and becomes as playful as a kitten.

Q4 RL.4.3

What problem comes after Rose stops the cattle thieves near Abilene?

- **A.** A flood washes away the ranch.
- **B.** The mighty sun causes a drought, and the thirsty cattle grow angry.
- **C.** The cattle run away in the snow.
- **D.** Rose loses her branding iron.

Q5 RL.4.3

How does Rose finally stop the two tornadoes?

- **A.** She runs away and hides in the barn.
- **B.** She reaches into her own heart, unleashes her song of thunder, and the calmed tornadoes rage no more.
- **C.** She throws her branding iron at them.
- **D.** She waits for the sheriff to help.

Q6 RL.4.6

The story is told by a narrator who says, "I recall most vividly the night she came into this world." Who is telling the story?

- **A.** Rose herself, as a baby.
- **B.** The outlaw Jesse Baines.
- **C.** The doctor's pet dog.
- **D.** A storyteller who was there and remembers Rose's life.

Q7 RL.4.5

"Thunder Rose" is a tall tale. Which feature shows that it belongs to this genre?

- **A.** It uses wild exaggeration about a hero with superhuman abilities.
- **B.** It gives step-by-step directions.
- **C.** It uses rhyme on every line.
- **D.** It lists real facts about the weather.

Q8 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the main LESSON, or theme, of "Thunder Rose"?

- **A.** Rose builds a strong fence all by herself at the age of five.
- **B.** Rose makes a thunderbolt out of scrap iron and names it Cole.
- **C.** Your greatest strength can come from within, not just from your muscles.
- **D.** A bad windstorm can ruin a ranch and scatter the frightened cattle.

Selection 2 · In the Days of King Adobe

FOLKTALE · AS TOLD BY JOE HAYES (ILLUS. UTE SIMON) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.4.2

What is "In the Days of King Adobe" mainly about?

- **A.** How to cook a ham for a feast.
- **B.** A clever old woman who outwits two young men who try to steal her ham.
- **C.** A king named Hambone who rules a real country.
- **D.** Two friends who build a house together.

Q10 RL.4.3

How does the old woman live at the start of the story?

- **A.** She is rich and lives in a palace.
- **B.** She owns a large farm with many workers.
- **C.** She travels from town to town with no home.
- **D.** She is very poor, lives alone in a tiny house, and eats mostly beans, tortillas, and cornmeal mush.

Q11 RL.4.3

After the young men hide the ham in their bag, what does the old woman do?

- **A.** She takes the ham back and wraps an adobe brick in the shirt instead.
- **B.** She wakes them and asks for the ham back.
- **C.** She calls the village guards.
- **D.** She lets them keep the ham and says nothing.

Q12 RL.4.3

Why does the old woman tell the men her "dream" about King Hambone being replaced by Adobe the Great?

- **A.** She really had that dream and wants to share it.
- **B.** She wants the men to stay longer.
- **C.** She is hinting that she swapped the ham ("Hambone") for an adobe brick ("Adobe").
- **D.** She is trying to scare them away from her house.

Q13 RL.4.6

At first the reader expects the two young men to be the tricksters. What twist does the author create?

- **A.** The ham comes back to life.
- **B.** A real king arrives at the house.
- **C.** The kind old woman turns out to be the real trickster.
- **D.** The men give the woman their own food.

Q14 RL.4.3

What happens to the two young men at the end of the folktale?

- ◯ **A.** They open the bag to find a brick, go hungry, and stop playing tricks on kind people.
- ◯ **B.** They become rich kings.
- ◯ **C.** They move into the old woman's house.
- ◯ **D.** They steal another ham right away.

Q15 RL.4.5

"In the Days of King Adobe" is a folktale. Which feature is typical of this genre?

- ◯ **A.** It gives the exact dates of real events.
- ◯ **B.** It is written as a list of rules.
- ◯ **C.** It has no characters at all.
- ◯ **D.** It is a story handed down in a culture that teaches a moral, or lesson.

Q16 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the main LESSON, or theme, of "In the Days of King Adobe"?

- ◯ **A.** The old woman saves one penny a day to buy a special ham.
- ◯ **B.** Do not be greedy or dishonest, or you may end up with nothing.
- ◯ **C.** The two young men sleep on a blanket spread out on the floor.
- ◯ **D.** Ham is a fine food to eat on special days and holidays.

Selection 3 · A Pair of Tricksters

FABLE / TRICKSTER TALE · AESOP AND JOHN & CAITLIN MATTHEWS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.4.2

"A Pair of Tricksters" is made of two short fables. What do both fables show?

- ◯ **A.** Two animals build a nest together.
- ◯ **B.** A fox and a raven become best friends.
- ◯ **C.** Birds learn how to fly south for winter.
- ◯ **D.** A clever animal uses flattery to trick another animal out of its food.

Q18 RL.4.3

In "The Fox and the Crow," how does the Fox get the Crow's cheese?

- ◯ **A.** He climbs the tree and grabs it.
- ◯ **B.** He flatters her about her voice until she opens her beak to sing, and the cheese falls.
- ◯ **C.** He frightens her so she drops it.
- ◯ **D.** He trades her a fish for it.

Q19 RL.4.3

In "Raven and Crayfish," how is Raven different from the Crow?

- ◯ **A.** Raven cannot hear the flattery at all.
- ◯ **B.** Raven drops his food right away, just like the Crow.
- ◯ **C.** Raven is smarter and keeps his beak clamped shut at first, holding on to his dinner.
- ◯ **D.** Raven gives the crayfish to the fox.

Q20 RL.4.3

What finally makes Raven lose his dinner?

- ◯ **A.** Flattered into agreeing, he opens his beak, and the crayfish wriggles free into the lake.
- ◯ **B.** A strong wind blows it away.
- ◯ **C.** He drops it into his nest by accident.
- ◯ **D.** The fox steals it from him.

Q21 RL.4.5

A **fable** is a short story that —

- ◯ **A.** is meant to teach a lesson, called a moral, often using animal characters.
- ◯ **B.** reports true news from around the world.
- ◯ **C.** is always written in rhyme.
- ◯ **D.** has no beginning or end.

Q22 RL.4.6

In both fables, the trickster wins by using flattery. What is flattery?

- ◯ **A.** Telling someone the plain truth.
- ◯ **B.** Shouting loudly at someone.
- ◯ **C.** Saying nice things you do not really mean in order to get something.
- ◯ **D.** Giving someone a gift.

Q23 RL.4.6

At the end of "The Fox and the Crow," the Fox gives the Crow some "advice." What is the point of his advice?

- ◯ **A.** To teach the Crow how to sing better.
- ◯ **B.** To point out the moral: "Do not trust flatterers."
- ◯ **C.** To invite the Crow to dinner.
- ◯ **D.** To ask the Crow for more cheese.

Q24 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the main LESSON, or theme, shared by both fables in "A Pair of Tricksters"?

- ◯ **A.** The Crow's cheese falls down to the ground below the tree.
- ◯ **B.** Crayfish live in cool lakes and can wriggle out of a beak.
- ◯ **C.** Ravens are usually bigger birds than crows are.
- ◯ **D.** Do not trust flattery — even a clever creature can be fooled by praise.

Selection 4 · Ten Suns / The Ten Suns

LEGEND & VIDEO · RETOLD BY ERIC A. KIMMEL (ILLUS. YONGSHENG XUAN) · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.4.2

What is "Ten Suns" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How to build a jade palace.
- ◯ **B.** A real history of the weather in China.
- ◯ **C.** Ten sun-children who disobey their parents and nearly destroy the earth, until an archer stops them.
- ◯ **D.** A boy who learns to ride a dragon for fun.

Q26 RL.4.3

Why do the ten suns decide to walk across the sky all together?

- ◯ **A.** They are bored walking alone and think it would be more fun to go together.
- ◯ **B.** Their parents order them to.
- ◯ **C.** The earth asks them to.
- ◯ **D.** They want to put out a fire.

Q27 RL.4.3

What happens to the earth when all ten suns shine at once?

- ◯ **A.** It snows and the rivers freeze.
- ◯ **B.** Crops wither, forests catch fire, rivers dry up, and the sea begins to boil.
- ◯ **C.** Nothing changes at all.
- ◯ **D.** A great flood covers the land.

Q28 RL.4.3

Why does Di Jun send the archer Hu Yi to shoot down the suns?

- ◯ **A.** He is angry that the suns sleep too much.
- ◯ **B.** He wants the sky to be darker for sleeping.
- ◯ **C.** He wants to give Hu Yi a reward.
- ◯ **D.** The boys will not stop, and he must save the dying earth even though they are his sons.

Q29 RL.4.3

Why does one sun remain in the sky at the end?

- ◯ **A.** Emperor Shun sends a messenger to steal Hu Yi's last arrow, so Hu Yi stops.
- ◯ **B.** Hu Yi runs out of strength.
- ◯ **C.** One sun hides behind a mountain.
- ◯ **D.** Di Jun changes his mind and stops the archer.

Q30 RL.4.3

In the print legend, what do the nine fallen suns become?

- ◯ **A.** Bright stars in the sky.
- ◯ **B.** Drops of rain.
- ◯ **C.** Small fish in the sea.
- ◯ **D.** Black-feathered birds — crows that gather to greet the dawn.

Q31 RL.4.5

"Ten Suns" is a legend. Which statement best describes a legend?

- ◯ **A.** A set of true, provable facts about the sky.
- ◯ **B.** A story from the past believed by many people that cannot be proved true and often explains how things came to be.
- ◯ **C.** A poem with rhyming lines.
- ◯ **D.** A list of steps to follow.

Q32 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the main LESSON, or theme, of "Ten Suns"?

- ◯ **A.** The ten suns put on their brightest garments before the ride.
- ◯ **B.** Hu Yi once invented the bow and arrow long ago.
- ◯ **C.** Obey your parents and think of others — selfish acts can harm everyone.
- ◯ **D.** The dragon chariot is hard to ride across the wide sky.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 7 · Tricksters and Tall Tales · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about the lessons we learn from characters in traditional tales. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Heroism DOK 3

In **"Thunder Rose,"** a larger-than-life hero solves a huge problem. Show WHAT problem Rose faces, then explain HOW she finally solves it and what lesson it teaches.

A LARGER-THAN-LIFE HERO · THUNDER ROSE

THE PROBLEM	HOW SHE SOLVES IT	THE LESSON

Rose stops a stampede and tames a steer, but the tornadoes are her hardest test. Why is finding the song in her OWN heart a greater power than her super-strength? Explain.

Q2 Cleverness DOK 3

In **"In the Days of King Adobe,"** a poor old woman turns out to be the real trickster. Show WHAT the two young men do, then explain HOW the old woman outsmarts them.

CLEVERNESS OVER GREED · KING ADOBE

THE GREEDY PLAN	THE CLEVER TRICK	THE RESULT
what do the men try?	*what does the woman do?*	*what happens to the men?*

The old woman is poor, yet she is shrewd. Why is being clever more powerful than being greedy in this folktale? Explain.

Q3 Deception DOK 3

In **"A Pair of Tricksters,"** two fables show how flattery is used as a trick. Compare the TWO fables, then explain the lesson they share.

TWO TRICKSTERS · A PAIR OF TRICKSTERS

THE FOX AND THE CROW

RAVEN AND CRAYFISH

In both fables, flattery is the trick. Why is "Do not trust flatterers" a lesson that still matters today? Explain.

Q4 Consequences DOK 3

In **"Ten Suns,"** the sun-children make a choice that brings great harm. Show the CAUSE of the trouble, then explain the EFFECT and the lesson it teaches.

ACTIONS HAVE CONSEQUENCES · TEN SUNS

THE CHOICE (CAUSE)	WHAT HAPPENS (EFFECT)

The boys did not stop to think of others. Why is it important to consider the result of your actions before you act? Use the word *consequence* in your answer.

Q5 Inquiry DOK 4

Essential Question: What lessons can you learn from characters in traditional tales? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

Which character is this, and what lesson do they teach?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

Which character is this, and what lesson do they teach?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 7 · Tricksters and Tall Tales · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · How Bear Lost His Tail

Long ago, Bear had a long, bushy tail, and he was very proud of it. One cold winter day, he met Fox sitting by a hole in the ice. Fox had a row of fish laid out on the snow. "How did you catch so many fish?" asked Bear. Fox was a trickster, and he wanted to play a joke. "It is easy," said Fox. "Just drop your fine tail into the hole and wait. The fish will grab on. The longer you wait, the more you will catch." Bear sat down and dropped his tail into the icy water. He waited and waited. The night grew colder, and the water began to freeze around his tail. But Bear thought the heavy feeling meant fish were biting. At last, when the sky turned pink, Bear jumped up to pull out his catch. Snap! His frozen tail broke off in the ice. Fox laughed and ran away. From that day on, Bear has had only a short, stubby tail. And he has never trusted a smiling fox again. That is why, even now, bears have such short tails.

187 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1 RIT 200 · Lexile 500L · Key Detail

What did Bear look like at the beginning of the story?

- ◯ **A.** He had no tail at all.
- ◯ **B.** He had short, white fur.
- ◯ **C.** He had a long, bushy tail he was proud of.
- ◯ **D.** He had wings like a bird.

Q2 RIT 202 · Lexile 520L · Key Detail

What does Fox tell Bear to do to catch fish?

- ◯ **A.** Drop his tail into the hole and wait.
- ◯ **B.** Swim under the ice.
- ◯ **C.** Use a net and a pole.
- ◯ **D.** Build a fire on the ice.

Q3 RIT 203 · Lexile 530L · Cause & Effect

Why does Bear's tail break off?

- ◯ **A.** A fish bit it off.
- ◯ **B.** Fox pulled it.
- ◯ **C.** He stepped on it.
- ◯ **D.** The water froze around it, and it snapped when Bear jumped up.

Q4 RIT 205 · Lexile 550L · Inference

What kind of character is Fox in this story?

- ◯ **A.** A shy, quiet animal.
- ◯ **B.** A trickster who fools Bear for fun.
- ◯ **C.** A kind helper who shares his fish.
- ◯ **D.** A slow, sleepy animal.

Q5 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Main Idea

What does this tale mostly explain?

- ◯ **A.** Why bears have short tails — and the danger of trusting a trickster.
- ◯ **B.** How to catch many fish through a hole in winter ice.
- ◯ **C.** Why foxes choose to live deep in the woods.
- ◯ **D.** How thick ice slowly forms on a lake in winter.

Passage 2 · Anansi and the Wisdom Pot

In many old tales from West Africa, Anansi the spider is a famous trickster. In one story, Anansi decided that he would gather all the wisdom in the world and keep it for himself. He found a large clay pot and went around collecting every clever idea he could find. Soon the pot was full. Anansi wanted to hide the pot at the top of a tall tree, where no one else could reach it. He tied the heavy pot to the front of his body and began to climb. But the pot kept bumping against the tree trunk and getting in his way. He slipped again and again. His young son watched from below. "Father," the boy called, "why not tie the pot to your back? Then you can climb easily." Anansi was surprised. His little son had thought of something so clever, even though Anansi was holding all the wisdom in the world! In his anger, Anansi let go of the pot. It fell and broke, and the wisdom scattered on the wind to every corner of the earth. That is why no single person can ever hold all the wisdom — a little of it belongs to everyone.

201 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Key Detail

What does Anansi try to gather and keep for himself?

- A. All the gold in the world.
- B. All the food in the village.
- C. All the water in the river.
- D. All the wisdom in the world.

Q7 RIT 208 · Lexile 580L · Key Detail

Why does Anansi keep slipping as he climbs the tree?

- A. The tree is covered in ice.
- B. The pot, tied to the front of his body, keeps bumping the trunk and getting in his way.
- C. A strong wind is blowing.
- D. His son is pulling on his leg.

Q8 RIT 209 · Lexile 590L · Inference

Why is Anansi surprised by his son's idea?

- A. The boy thought of something clever even though Anansi was holding all the wisdom.
- B. The boy is much older than Anansi.
- C. The boy has climbed the tree before.
- D. The boy is also a spider.

Q9 RIT 210 · Lexile 600L · Cause & Effect

What happens to the wisdom after the pot breaks?

- A. It sinks into the river.
- B. Anansi puts it back in a new pot.
- C. It scatters on the wind to every corner of the earth.
- D. The son keeps all of it.

Q10 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Main Idea

What lesson does this trickster tale teach?

- A. Spiders are very good at climbing tall trees.
- B. No single person can hold all the wisdom — a little of it belongs to everyone.
- C. Clay pots break easily when they are dropped.
- D. It is best to climb trees late at night.

Passage 3 · Pecos Bill and the Cyclone

Pecos Bill was the greatest cowboy who ever lived — at least, that is what the tall tales say. People claimed he was raised by coyotes and could ride almost anything. One summer, a terrible cyclone came roaring across the plains. It was the biggest, meanest twister anyone had ever seen. It tore up fences, tossed wagons through the air, and ripped whole barns off the ground. The other cowboys ran for cover, but not Bill. He just grinned. As the cyclone spun past, Bill leaped onto its back as if it were a wild horse. The cyclone bucked and twisted, trying to throw him off. It spun so hard that it flattened mountains and dug out riverbeds. But Bill held on tight and would not let go. He rode that cyclone across three states. At last the storm grew tired. It rained itself out and shrank down to a gentle breeze. Bill slid off, dusted off his hat, and walked home. Folks say the deep canyons and dry gullies of the Southwest were carved out that very day, when Pecos Bill rode the cyclone until it gave up. Of course, it is only a story — but what a story it is.

203 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 211–216

Q11 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

According to the tall tale, who raised Pecos Bill?

- ◯ **A.** Coyotes.
- ◯ **B.** A family of farmers.
- ◯ **C.** A herd of cattle.
- ◯ **D.** A team of sailors.

Q12 RIT 212 · Lexile 640L · Key Detail

What does Bill do when the cyclone spins past?

- ◯ **A.** He runs for cover with the other cowboys.
- ◯ **B.** He ropes it with a lasso.
- ◯ **C.** He leaps onto its back and rides it like a wild horse.
- ◯ **D.** He hides inside a barn.

Q13 RIT 213 · Lexile 660L · Vocabulary

The passage says the cyclone "bucked and twisted, trying to throw him off." In this sentence, **bucked** means —

- ◯ **A.** stood perfectly still.
- ◯ **B.** jumped and kicked wildly, like a horse.
- ◯ **C.** floated softly in the air.
- ◯ **D.** fell fast asleep.

Q14 RIT 215 · Lexile 680L · Inference

The tale says Bill's ride carved the canyons and gullies of the Southwest. This is an example of —

- ◯ **A.** a true scientific fact.
- ◯ **B.** a set of directions.
- ◯ **C.** a real weather report.
- ◯ **D.** exaggeration used to make the hero seem larger than life.

Q15 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Pecos Bill and the Cyclone"?

- ◯ **A.** Cyclones are very common on the open plains.
- ◯ **B.** Cowboys should always run away from bad storms.
- ◯ **C.** In a tall tale, a fearless hero does impossible, exaggerated feats.
- ◯ **D.** The Southwest gets very little rain each year.

Passage 4 · The Lion and the Mouse

One warm afternoon, a great lion lay sleeping in the shade. A tiny mouse, not watching where she ran, scampered right across the lion's paw. The lion woke with a roar and trapped the little mouse beneath his huge claw. "How dare you wake me!" he growled. "I shall make a meal of you." The frightened mouse begged for her life. "Please let me go," she squeaked. "I am only a small mouse. But one day I may be able to help you in return." The lion laughed at the thought. How could such a tiny creature ever help the king of beasts? Still, he was amused, so he lifted his paw and let her scurry away. Some days later, the lion was caught in a hunter's net. He roared and struggled, but the thick ropes held him fast. The little mouse heard his cries and hurried to the spot. Quickly she set to work, gnawing through the ropes with her sharp teeth. One by one the strands snapped, until the lion was free. "You laughed when I said I might help you," said the mouse. "Now you see that even a small friend can do a great deed." The lion never laughed at the mouse again.

207 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Key Detail

How does the mouse first wake the lion?

- ◯ **A.** She squeaks loudly in his ear.
- ◯ **B.** She runs right across his paw.
- ◯ **C.** She bites his tail.
- ◯ **D.** She drops a nut on his head.

Q17 RIT 217 · Lexile 720L · Cause & Effect

Why does the lion let the mouse go?

- ◯ **A.** He is too full to eat her.
- ◯ **B.** A hunter scares him away.
- ◯ **C.** The mouse bites his claw.
- ◯ **D.** He is amused by her promise to help him one day.

Q18 RIT 218 Lexile 740L Cause & Effect

How does the mouse free the lion from the hunter's net?

- **A.** She calls the other animals for help.
- **B.** She unties the knots with her paws.
- **C.** She gnaws through the ropes with her sharp teeth.
- **D.** She frightens the hunter away.

Q19 RIT 219 Lexile 770L Vocabulary

The passage says the mouse began "gnawing through the ropes." The word **gnawing** means —

- **A.** biting and chewing at them again and again.
- **B.** tying them in knots.
- **C.** washing them clean.
- **D.** painting them a new color.

Q20 RIT 220 Lexile 800L Main Idea

What is the moral, or lesson, of "The Lion and the Mouse"?

- **A.** Lions like to sleep in the cool shade.
- **B.** Mice have very sharp little teeth.
- **C.** Hunters use big nets to trap wild animals.
- **D.** Even a small friend can do a great deed — kindness is worth giving.